

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

absorb so many ideas and judgements by osmosis from the headlines and from social media that we can become ashamed and anxious without even really knowing where those feelings are coming from. If we're not careful, we can find ourselves trying to measure up to thirty different people's ideas about what it means to be 'good with money', when we haven't even stopped to consider whether or why those opinions should mean anything to us. Often, we haven't even qualified for ourselves what having a healthy relationship with money would look like for us, and therefore become more susceptible to the opinions of others.

So, we've established that boundaries are important, but how on earth does a thoroughly unboundaried person begin to put them in place? Here, I turn again to Nedra Glover Tawwab and her invaluable book¹⁰ for guidance, along with some other methods that I have found useful in practice. As we go through what setting or reinforcing your boundaries could look like, and how it applies to financial wellbeing, I'd suggest that you make notes whenever questions are posed, because it will give you something solid to come back to later on, and help you to follow through with your boundary setting.

The first step is to identify where boundaries are needed, or where porous boundaries might need some reinforcement. Tawwab defines porous boundaries as those that we believe that we have put in place, but fail to enforce or communicate, which can lead to feelings of resentment, and one of the examples that she gives is agreeing to loan someone money